



Socialism 101: Why Mark Norman Opposes Democratic Socialism

A practical guide to why Mark believes Oregon House District 27 needs opportunity, accountability, public safety, economic growth, and individual freedom, not larger government and centralized control.

Mark Norman

OREGON HD-27 • REPUBLICAN • 2026

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101

Mark believes Oregon needs **a different path.**

Mark Norman does not support socialism, democratic socialism, or the idea that Oregon's future should depend on larger government, higher taxes, expanded bureaucracy, and more centralized control.

Mark believes Oregon needs a different path.

That path is built on opportunity, accountability, public safety, educational excellence, economic growth, individual freedom, strong communities, small-business growth, and responsible government.

Many voters hear the word “socialism” and wonder what it actually means. This guide explains what democratic socialism means in public policy, what the Democratic Socialists of America supports, and why Mark believes Oregon House District 27 should choose practical leadership over a larger-government agenda.

Mark shares the desire for affordable healthcare, strong schools, safe neighborhoods, and a fair chance for every Oregon family.

But he strongly disagrees with the belief that more government control is the best way to achieve those goals.

What socialism means in public policy.

At its core, socialism is a political and economic philosophy that seeks a much larger role for government in providing services, directing economic activity, redistributing wealth, and controlling major parts of the economy through taxation, regulation, public programs, and public ownership.

In practical terms, that often means more decisions being shifted away from families, entrepreneurs, local communities, private employers, and individual citizens, and toward government agencies, public systems, and centralized planning.

Mark believes that approach is wrong for Oregon.

He believes government has important responsibilities, but it should not become the center of economic life, family decision-making, healthcare decisions, small-business survival, energy policy, transportation planning, or local community direction.

What the Democratic Socialists of America supports.

The **Democratic Socialists of America** describes itself as the largest socialist organization in the United States and says it believes working people should run both the economy and society democratically.

DSA's 2024 program includes support for higher taxes on wealthy earners and corporations, Medicare for All, expanded labor power, and public ownership over major transportation and energy infrastructure and natural resources.

Mark believes voters should understand what that means.

This is not simply a normal debate about spending more on schools, healthcare, or housing. It is a much broader debate about who should control major parts of the economy and public life.

Mark believes those decisions should remain rooted in individual freedom, private enterprise, local communities, accountable government, and constitutional limits, not a socialist model of expanded government control.

Government should serve people, **not simply grow larger.**

Mark believes Oregon needs reform, accountability, and compassion.

But he does not believe Oregon needs to replace capitalism, weaken private enterprise, or move major sectors of the economy under public ownership.

Large government-centered systems can create serious unintended consequences:

- ★ Higher taxes and fees
- ★ Higher energy and utility costs
- ★ More regulation
- ★ More bureaucracy
- ★ Less local flexibility
- ★ Fewer choices
- ★ Slower services
- ★ Programs measured by spending instead of results

Mark believes America's success has been built on individual liberty, private property rights, entrepreneurship, free enterprise, strong families, local communities, and the opportunity for people to improve their lives through hard work and personal initiative.

Why this matters in House District 27.

This issue is not theoretical.

House District 27 voters deserve to understand the different governing philosophies being presented to them.

This election is about more than personalities. It is about two very different views of government.

One view depends on larger government, higher taxes, more centralized control, and expanded public systems.

Mark's view depends on opportunity, accountability, public safety, educational excellence, economic growth, individual freedom, and practical leadership.

Mark respects the right of others to hold different political beliefs. He respects public service and civic participation. But he also believes voters deserve clarity.

When a candidate publicly identifies with a national political organization, voters have a right to ask which parts of that organization's agenda they support and which parts they reject.

That is especially important when the organization's stated platform includes a much larger role for government in healthcare, housing, education, labor policy, taxation, climate policy, transportation, energy, and public ownership of major economic sectors.

Mark's position is clear.

- ★ He supports fully funding public safety, recruiting and retaining qualified police officers, holding criminals accountable, and giving law enforcement the tools needed to keep neighborhoods safe.
- ★ He supports strong schools focused on academic excellence, reading, math, discipline, and opportunity.
- ★ He supports lower costs for working families, a better climate for small businesses, and government that respects taxpayers.
- ★ He supports helping vulnerable Oregonians, but he believes public programs must be accountable, effective, and measured by results.

Mark trusts the voters of House District 27 to study the issues, compare the visions, and decide which path will best serve the community and the state.

Two different philosophies of government.

Bigger-Government Approach

- ★ More centralized control
- ★ More mandates from Salem
- ★ Higher taxes and fees
- ★ Expanded bureaucracy
- ★ Government-run systems
- ★ Less flexibility for families, schools, and communities
- ★ Programs measured by spending and size
- ★ More pressure on taxpayers and employers

Mark Norman's Practical Approach

- ★ Responsible spending
- ★ Local flexibility
- ★ Small-business growth
- ★ Parent transparency
- ★ Public safety with accountability
- ★ Healthcare choice
- ★ Reliable energy
- ★ Animal welfare with respect for responsible ownership
- ★ Veteran support that delivers real help
- ★ Programs measured by results

Mark believes Oregon needs service, solutions, and accountability.

Mark Norman's 9 issue priorities.

1. ANIMAL WELFARE

Humane treatment and responsible ownership **can work together.**

Mark Norman is a veterinarian with more than 30 years of experience serving Oregon communities. He supports practical, science-based animal welfare policies that reduce cruelty, neglect, and pet overpopulation.

He supports education, access to veterinary care, rescue support, and responsible spay and neuter programs.

Mark believes Oregon can protect animals while respecting families, veterinarians, farmers, ranchers, hunters, and responsible pet owners.

MARK'S POSITION

Animal welfare should be humane, practical, science-based, and respectful of responsible ownership.

2. DATA CENTERS

Innovation should not come at the expense of **local communities.**

Data centers are increasingly important to technology, artificial intelligence, cloud computing, and Oregon's long-term economic competitiveness.

Mark supports responsible data center development, but he believes growth must be balanced with clear standards for electricity demand, water use, land pressure, utility costs, infrastructure impact, and fair tax contribution.

MARK'S POSITION

Oregon can support innovation while requiring accountability, reliable energy planning, and protection for local communities.

02

3. EDUCATION

Strong basics. Real skills. Parents in the loop.

Mark believes Oregon schools should focus on reading, writing, math, science, civics, discipline, critical thinking, and career readiness.

He supports evidence-based instruction, parent transparency, clear academic standards, safe classrooms, local flexibility, and vocational pathways.

MARK'S POSITION

Teachers should be empowered to teach, parents should be respected as partners, and students should graduate prepared for adult life.

03

4. LOCAL ISSUES OVER IDEOLOGY

Oregon problems need Oregon solutions.

Mark believes many Oregonians are tired of division, hostility, and ideological purity tests.

He believes people of different backgrounds, faiths, viewpoints, and political beliefs should be able to live and work together respectfully.

The state legislature should stay focused on Oregon issues: affordability, schools, public safety, small business, energy costs, transportation, housing, and government accountability.

MARK'S POSITION

People do not need to agree on every national issue to work together on local problems.

04

5. PUBLIC SAFETY

Compassion and safety **belong together.**

Public safety is one of government's basic responsibilities.

Mark supports fully funding public safety, improving recruitment and retention, supporting strong training, strengthening community policing, expanding behavioral health partnerships, and addressing addiction, mental illness, homelessness, and repeat-offender challenges.

MARK'S POSITION

Oregonians should not have to choose between compassion and safety. We need both.

05

6. SMALL BUSINESS

Small businesses need **room to grow.**

Small businesses are the backbone of Oregon's economy.

Mark believes Oregon should reduce unnecessary regulations, streamline permitting, review excessive fees, improve access to capital and workforce training, protect independent contractors and small employers, and support local job creation.

MARK'S POSITION

Small businesses should be treated as partners in economic growth, not endless sources of revenue.

06

7. TRANSPORTATION & ENERGY

Infrastructure should be based on reality, **not ideology.**

Mark supports transportation and energy policies grounded in affordability, reliability, mobility, and measurable public benefit.

He supports public transportation, but believes major projects should be evaluated based on actual rider behavior, costs, safety, and long-term sustainability.

He also supports an all-of-the-above energy strategy that includes hydroelectric, natural gas, renewables, and next-generation nuclear power.

MARK'S POSITION

Oregon should invest in infrastructure people actually use and energy systems that reliably work.

07

8. HEALTHCARE

Healthcare should be patient-centered, **not** **bureaucracy-centered.**

Mark believes healthcare costs are too high, insurance bureaucracy is frustrating, and too many families delay care because they are worried about affordability.

He does not support a government-run single-payer healthcare system for Oregon.

Instead, he supports practical reforms focused on affordability, access, transparency, patient choice, provider support, rural and community care, mental health, and addiction treatment.

MARK'S POSITION

Healthcare decisions should stay primarily between patients and healthcare professionals, not centralized through expanding government control.

08

9. VETERAN SUPPORT

Veterans deserve dignity, respect, and real support.

As a retired Navy veteran, Mark understands that service leaves a lasting impact long after the uniform comes off.

He supports improving access to healthcare, mental health services, addiction treatment, housing assistance, workforce training, career transition support, and employment opportunities for veterans and military families.

MARK'S POSITION

Veterans fulfilled their commitment to this country. Government and society should fulfill their commitment to them.

09

There's room **to help.**

Campaigns are built by people who stay involved.

There are many ways to participate depending on your time, schedule, and comfort level.

WAYS TO GET INVOLVED

- ★ Share this guide
- ★ Sign up for campaign updates
- ★ Ask Mark a question
- ★ Attend a local event
- ★ Volunteer with the campaign
- ★ Walk a neighborhood
- ★ Make calls from home
- ★ Host a coffee or meet-and-greet
- ★ Review official contribution information
- ★ Make a plan to vote in 2026

The first step is staying informed. The next step is choosing how you want to be involved.

To learn more, visit the campaign website at markfororegon.com.

A different path for Oregon House District 27.

This election is about more than personalities. It is about two different philosophies of government.

One vision depends on larger government, higher taxes, expanded bureaucracy, and more centralized control.

Mark Norman's vision depends on opportunity, accountability, public safety, educational excellence, economic growth, individual freedom, local problem-solving, and practical leadership.

He trusts the voters of House District 27 to study the issues, compare the visions, and decide which path will best serve the community and the state.

SERVICE · SOLUTIONS · ACCOUNTABILITY

WEBSITE

markfororegon.com

PHONE

+1 971-278-6520

EMAIL

mark@markfororegon.com

MAIL

PO Box 122 · Beaverton, OR 97075

FB · IG · X · TT — @MARKFORHD27

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